BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

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Estimate Change


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US Communications Infrastructure

CoreWeave, Inc.

Rating

Underperform

Price Target

CRWV **54.00 USD** (51.00 *OLD*)

CoreWeave (CRWV): Reexamining the backlog funding math

CRWV has been on a downslide since October 14, mostly due to questions around its funding, but also because the company is the tip of the whip for the AI trade - highest highs and lowest lows when there is widespread sentiment shift.

Since we published last week, we've re-examined our estimates for the capital CRWV needs to deliver its ~$129B contracted backlog. Candidly, our prior estimates were too high (~$75B incremental required). We built that analysis on an individual customer contract-ramp basis, which remains useful for the demand side of our model and allows us to more tightly tie capacity to large buyers (MSFT, META). However, applying that framework to the funding analysis depressed the implied revenue-to-capex relationship and pushed more spend into the remaining build, overstating the incremental funding requirement.

We have revised our estimates using a power-based approach: for their signed backlog, we believe CRWV requires $44-68B of new capex, with ~$18-42B left to raise—a much lower but still-meaningful number. If you expand to consider the contracted capacity CRWV intends to bring online by EOY 2028 (approaching 4.2GW total), those numbers increase to $95-122B of new capex, ~$70-96B of which would be left to raise, though that additional capacity would presumably also be supported by incremental contracts and significant backlog growth.

As we wrote last week, our broader concern is less about whether CRWV can fund the existing backlog than the rising cost of each incremental dollar of capital as the company shifts toward shorter-dated enterprise contracts. That remains the catch-22 in the strategy: incremental growth requires incremental funding, while the contract duration supporting that funding is shortening. We continue to see risk on both sides of that equation.

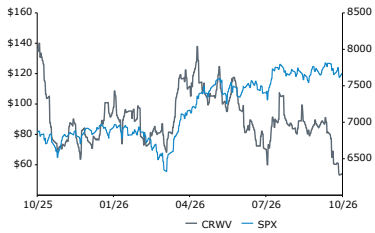
There remains meaningful uncertainty around these estimates given limited company disclosure. The company does not report MW attached to the signed backlog, backlog revenue per year (RPO comes in 24-month buckets), or GPU purchase commitments. Greater disclosure would allow us to refine these estimates further, but on our revised methodology, converting the existing backlog into revenue still requires a substantial amount of incremental capital. Despite the lower estimated funding gap, we remain cautious and **reiterate our Underperform rating with a revised PT of $54.**

Close Date	26 Oct 2026
CRWV Close Price (USD)	55.19
Price Target (USD)	54.00
Upside/(Downside)	(2)%
52-Week Range	141.79/51.24
SPX	7,676.77
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	NA
Market Cap (USD) (M)	30,439
EV (USD) (M)	76,508

Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	(22.9)	(37.0)	(49.9)	(58.4)
SPX (%)	12.1	(0.9)	7.1	13.0
Relative (%)	(35.1)	(36.1)	(57.0)	(71.4)

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
CRWV (USD)	(1.20)	(5.14)	**(6.60)**
OLD	--	--	(6.81)

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
EBITDA (M)	2,442	6,826	14,735	--
EBIT (M)	(12.62)	314.23	2,478	--

Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
EV/EBIT (x)	N/M	243	30.9
Adjusted P/E (x)	(46.1)	(10.7)	(8.4)

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our Global Research Disclosure Website.

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Investment Implications

We are Underperform on CRWV with a price target of $54 (prev $51), on moderately lower FY27 CapEx and corresponding debt raises. CRWV continues to benefit from persistent data center supply constraints; however, as capacity expands and those constraints ease, as we expect, we believe the company will be among the first and hardest hit. We maintain our target EV/EBIT multiple of 23.5x, primarily reflecting concerns around its cost of capital, especially as the company moves to shorter-dated contracts.

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DETAILS

EXHIBIT 1: **We estimate CoreWeave's incremental CapEx to fund the existing backlog to be $18-42B after deducting CIP, existing cash, and DDTL capacity**

CapEx to Fund Existing Backlog ($M)	Low	Base	High
CapEx per MW	35	40	45
Power Required	1,250	1,300	1,500
Incremental CapEx Required	43,750	52,000	67,500
(-) Construction in Progress	11,918	11,918	11,918
(-) Cash & Cash Equivalents	4,972	4,972	4,972
(-) Existing DDTL Capacity	9,062	9,062	9,062
Incremental Funding Required	**17,798**	**26,048**	**41,548**

1. We use $40M/MW per our BOM for a rack of Vera Rubin.

2. Assuming 90% of current cash on balance sheet, after cash needed for operations.
Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 2: **CoreWeave Implied Historical CapEx per MW**

To-Date CapEx per MW ($M)	As of 2Q26
PP&E, Net	69,217
Leasehold Improvements	5,997
Construction in Progress	11,918
Furniture / Machinery / Equipment	33,848
Software	859
Operating ROU Assets	16,595
Accumulated Depreciation	5,886
Cumulative CapEx (excl. CIP)	63,185
Cumulative CapEx / MW	**42**

Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 3: **Using our $40M/MW base case estimate, we estimate that CoreWeave will need $108B of incremental CapEx to reach 4.2GW and an additional $152B to reach 8GW**

CapEx to Fund Contracted Power ($M)	2H 2026	2027	2028+	By 2030	Total 2026-2030
Contracted Power BoP	1,500	1,850	3,000	4,200	**1,500**
(+) Power Additions	350	1,150	1,200	3,800	**6,500**
Contracted Power EoP	1,850	3,000	4,200	8,000	**8,000**
Incremental CapEx	**14,000**	**46,000**	**48,000**	**152,000**	**260,000**

1. We assume existing backlog represents a portion of 2H2026, 2027, and 2028 incremental power.
Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein estimates and analysis

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APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 4: **CRWV Income Statement Summary**

All values in millions, except per share data

	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	FY 2025	FY 2026	FY 2027	FY 2028	FY 2029
Total operating revenues	1,365	1,572	2,078	2,575	3,450	4,519	4,851	5,831	5,131	12,622	23,552	36,358	36,974
Cost of revenue	369	509	716	879	1,126	1,407	1,474	1,728	1,453	4,128	6,916	9,949	9,620
Technology & Infrastructure	747	950	1,273	1,507	1,967	2,486	2,621	3,107	2,929	7,234	12,483	18,544	18,360
Sales & Marketing	45	52	69	60	59	77	82	99	144	264	400	618	629
General & Administrative	152	150	164	178	221	267	263	316	651	830	1,275	1,968	2,001
Total operating expenses	1,313	1,661	2,222	2,624	3,373	4,237	4,440	5,249	5,177	12,456	21,074	31,079	30,610
Operating income	52	(89)	(144)	(49)	77	281	411	582	(45)	165	2,478	5,280	6,364
Total other (expense) income	(289)	(378)	(512)	(515)	(1,155)	(1,371)	(1,614)	(1,815)	(1,170)	(3,553)	(7,635)	(10,002)	(11,090)
Income (loss) from continuing operations before taxes	(237)	(467)	(656)	(564)	(1,078)	(1,090)	(1,203)	(1,233)	(1,215)	(3,388)	(5,157)	(4,723)	(4,725)
Income tax expense (benefit)	(127)	(15)	84	62	-	-	-	-	(48)	146	-	-	-
Net income (loss)	(110)	(452)	(740)	(626)	(1,078)	(1,090)	(1,203)	(1,233)	(1,167)	(3,534)	(5,157)	(4,723)	(4,725)
Dividends and accretions on Series C redeemable prefs	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	(29)	-	-	-	-
Net income (loss) attributable to common stockholders, basic	(110)	(452)	(740)	(626)	(1,078)	(1,090)	(1,203)	(1,233)	(1,196)	(3,534)	(5,157)	(4,723)	(4,725)
Change in fair value of common stock warrants	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	(27)	-	-	-	-
Net income available to common stockholders	(110)	(452)	(740)	(626)	(1,078)	(1,090)	(1,203)	(1,233)	(1,223)	(3,534)	(5,157)	(4,723)	(4,725)
(+) Adjustments	69	168	151	59	173	226	243	292	562	608	1,178	1,454	1,479
Adjusted Net Income	(41)	(284)	(589)	(567)	(906)	(864)	(961)	(942)	(606)	(2,925)	(3,979)	(3,268)	(3,246)
Earnings per share (EPS)													
EPS (basic)	(0.22)	(0.89)	(1.40)	(1.14)	(1.94)	(1.93)	(2.10)	(2.13)	(2.42)	(6.24)	(8.75)	(7.76)	(7.57)
EPS (diluted)	(0.22)	(0.89)	(1.40)	(1.14)	(1.93)	(1.91)	(2.08)	(2.10)	(2.42)	(6.20)	(8.55)	(7.46)	(7.16)
Adjusted EPS (diluted)	(0.08)	(0.56)	(1.12)	(1.03)	(1.62)	(1.52)	(1.66)	(1.61)	(1.20)	(5.14)	(6.60)	(5.16)	(4.92)

Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein estimates and analysis

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BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			26 Oct 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				EV/EBIT (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
CRWV (CoreWeave)	U	USD	55.19	**54.00**	(71.4)%	USD	(1.20)	(5.14)	**(6.60)**	N/M	243	30.9
OLD				51.00					(6.81)			
SPX			7,676.77									

PRICE TARGET CHANGE / ESTIMATE CHANGE IN BOLD

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY

CoreWeave, Inc.

We value CRWV on a forward EV/Adjusted EBIT multiple. Our $54 price target is based on an Enterprise Value calculated as 23.5x NTM+1 Adj. Operating Income of $5.2B.

RISKS

CoreWeave, Inc.

The main upside risks to our price target/Underperform rating on CRWV are 1) Delays in hyperscaler built capacity coming online may maintain CRWV value proposition, 2) Development of CRWV’s specialized software platform which maintains demand for CRWV operated data centers, and 3) Continued shortage in power supply to power data centers may sustain CRWV’s pricing power

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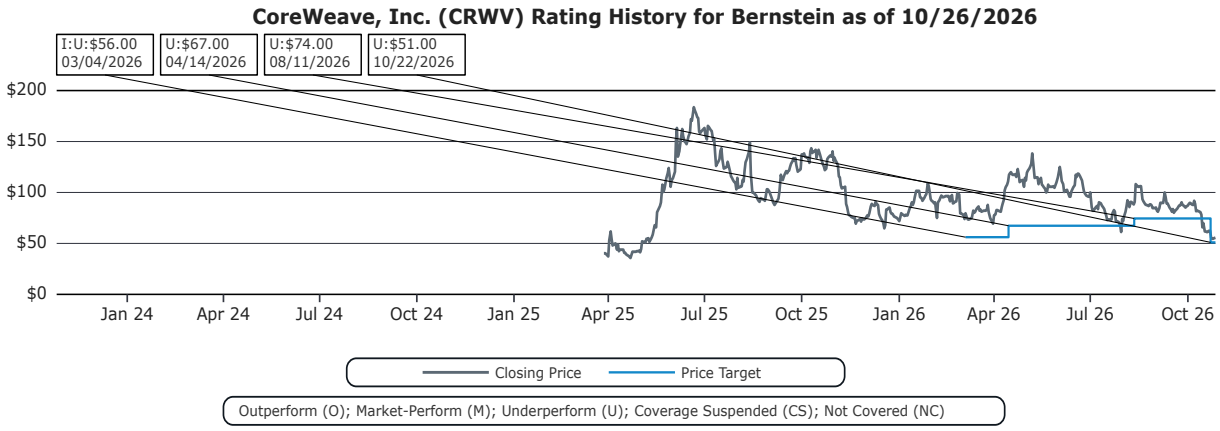
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Underperform	SELL	12.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
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